

FactoryLM / MIRA

Expo Discovery Questionnaire

Florida Automation Expo — May 21, 2026

FAST VERSION — 8 Questions for Quick Conversations

1. What's your role and what kind of equipment do you work with?
 2. **[MUST ASK]** When a machine goes down, how does your team figure out what's wrong?
 3. **[MUST ASK]** How easy is it to find the right manual, drawing, or fault history when you need it?
 4. **[MUST ASK]** On a scale of 1-5, how painful is the documentation problem at your plant? (1 = fine, 5 = constant struggle)
 5. **[MUST ASK]** If you could text a question about equipment and get a grounded answer with citations from your own manuals — would your team use that?
 6. What would make you NOT trust an AI system giving maintenance guidance?
 7. Who at your company would need to approve trying something like this?
 8. Would you be open to seeing a quick demo sometime — no pressure, just to see if it's relevant?
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DEEP VERSION — All 25 Questions

A. Quick Role / Context Questions

Goal: Understand who they are without making it feel like a form.

1. What's your role, and what kind of plant or facility do you work in?
2. What kind of equipment does your team maintain? (PLCs, VFDs, conveyors, cranes, packaging, HVAC, etc.)
3. How big is your maintenance team?
Follow-up: Is it mostly in-house techs, or do you use contractors/integrators?

B. Current Maintenance Workflow

Goal: Learn how they currently solve equipment problems.

4. **[MUST ASK]** When a machine goes down or throws a fault, walk me through what happens. How does your team figure out what's wrong?
Follow-up: Where does the tech go first — a binder, a computer, a phone call, or their own memory?
5. **[MUST ASK]** How much of your troubleshooting depends on one or two people who just "know" the equipment?
Follow-up: What happens when that person is on vacation or leaves?
6. Do your techs have access to equipment info on a phone or tablet, or is it mostly desktop/paper?

C. Documentation / Knowledge Pain

Goal: Find out if manuals, prints, drawings, fault history, and procedures are hard to find.

7. **[MUST ASK]** How easy is it to find the right manual, wiring diagram, or fault history when you need it?
Follow-up: Where does that stuff live — SharePoint, a file server, binders, someone's desk?

8. **[MUST ASK]** On a scale of 1-5, how painful is the documentation problem at your plant? (1 = organized, 5 = constant struggle)

9. When new equipment gets installed, how does the documentation make it into your system — if it does at all?

10. Have you ever had a situation where a tech couldn't find a manual or drawing and it cost real downtime?

Follow-up: How often does that happen — once a month, once a week?

D. PLC / Controls / Equipment Data

Goal: Understand whether PLC tags, VFD parameters, fault codes, and equipment data are accessible.

11. **[MUST ASK]** If a tech needs to check a PLC tag value, a VFD parameter, or look up a fault code — how do they do that today?

Follow-up: Do they have to find a laptop with the programming software, or is there a faster way?

12. Do you have any system that connects PLC/SCADA data to maintenance workflows — or are those completely separate worlds?

13. Have you looked at or heard of Unified Namespace, MQTT, or Sparkplug B for organizing plant data?

Follow-up: Is that something your team is exploring, or is it not on the radar yet?

E. AI / MIRA Concept Validation

Goal: Test whether they would actually want an AI maintenance assistant.

14. **[MUST ASK]** Imagine your tech could send a message describing a fault or question about equipment, and get back a grounded answer that cites the actual manual, drawing, or work order history. Would your team use that?

Follow-up: Would they trust it? What would make it useful versus annoying?

15. On a scale of 1-5, how likely would you be to try a system like that? (1 = no interest, 5 = I'd try it this week)

16. **[MUST ASK]** What would make you NOT trust an AI system giving maintenance guidance?

Follow-up: Is it about accuracy, safety, liability, or just not believing it works?

17. If this kind of tool existed, would your techs use it in Slack, Teams, text message, or something else?

F. QR Code / Asset Access Validation

Goal: Test whether scanning equipment to pull up asset context would be useful.

18. If you could scan a QR code on a machine and immediately pull up its manuals, fault history, wiring diagram, and last 5 work orders — would that be useful?

Follow-up: Do you already have asset tags or QR codes on equipment?

19. What information would be most valuable to see when you walk up to a machine?

G. Buying / Implementation Reality

Goal: Learn who would care, who would approve, and what would block adoption.

20. Who else at your company would care about a tool like this?

21. If you found something useful, what does the process look like to actually try it?

22. If a tool like this saved real troubleshooting time, what would a reasonable investment look like?

Note: Don't push if they're uncomfortable. Listen for budget signals.

23. What would make you walk away from a tool like this — even if it worked?

H. Closing Questions

Goal: Get the strongest quote, pain point, and next step.

24. If you could fix one thing about how your team finds and uses equipment knowledge, what would it be?

This is the money question. Let them talk. Write down exactly what they say.

25. [MUST ASK] Would you be open to seeing a short demo sometime — not a sales call, just a 10-minute walkthrough?

If yes: Can I grab your email? If no: Can I send you a one-pager?

HOW MIKE SHOULD USE THIS AT THE EXPO

Best Opening Line

"Hey, I'm Mike — I'm in maintenance, been doing it about 30 years. I'm building a tool to help techs find equipment information faster. I'm not here to sell anything, just trying to learn how other shops handle it. Mind if I ask you a couple quick questions?"

Best 15-Second MIRA Explanation

"We're building MIRA — it reads your actual manuals, wiring diagrams, and work order history, and lets a tech ask questions in plain language. Like texting someone who actually read all your documentation. It cites where it found the answer so you can verify it."

Tips for Natural Conversations

- Lead with your own experience: "At my last plant, we had this problem where..."
- Ask about THEIR world first. Don't pitch until they've told you their pain.
- Use "walk me through" instead of "tell me about" — it gets stories, not summaries.
- If they light up on a topic, stay there. Skip your script.
- If they're rushed, use the Fast Version. Get the email and follow up.

Strong Product-Market Fit Signals

- "Our senior guy is retiring and nobody knows what he knows"
- "We waste 30 minutes per call just finding the right manual"
- "Our documentation is a disaster"
- Pain score 4 or 5 / Likelihood score 4 or 5
- They ask YOU questions about how it works
- They volunteer their email without being asked

Weak Fit Signals

- "We've got everything pretty well organized"
- "Our CMMS handles all of that"
- Pain score 1 or 2 — don't push

Possible Pilot Customer Signals

- They describe a SPECIFIC pain — not generic
- They name a SPECIFIC machine, line, or situation
- They ask about pricing or timeline unprompted
- They offer to introduce you to someone else at their company
- They have 5+ maintenance techs

Follow Up After the Event If...

- Any pain score of 3+
- Any likelihood score of 3+
- They gave you their email or card
- They mentioned a specific problem MIRA could solve
- They asked about a demo